

SMOG AND ACID RAIN

Factories, power plants, road vehicles, aircraft, and even cooking fires release masses of soot and waste gas into the atmosphere every day. The soot and gases can cause dangerous clouds of thick, choking smog, especially in cities. Some gases may also combine with water vapor in the air to form acid rain, which kills trees and fish.



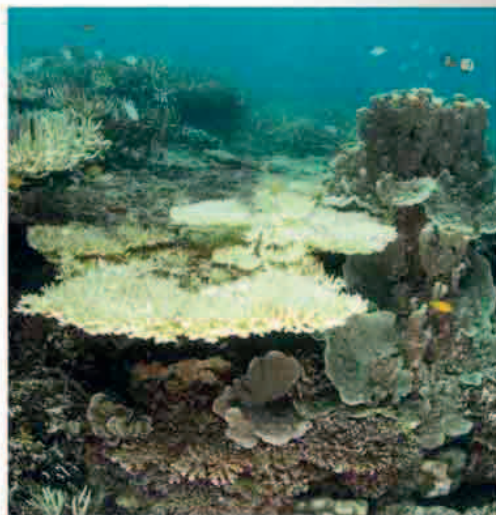
OIL SPILLS

Although shipwrecks are less common today thanks to advances in navigation technology, oil tankers still occasionally hit rocks and spill their cargoes into the sea. The oil is deadly to marine wildlife, and if it comes ashore it causes terrible coastal pollution.



▼ SMOG CITY

On a warm day, a thick layer of pollution from traffic fumes and industrial emissions settles over Jakarta, Indonesia.



ACIDIFIED OCEANS

Vehicles and factories release vast amounts of carbon dioxide into the atmosphere each day. Much of the gas is absorbed by the oceans and turns into carbonic acid, which is making the oceans less alkaline. This is disastrous for animals such as corals that cannot survive without alkaline minerals. This coral reef in the Philippines is dying.

FACT!

In December 1952, a four-day smog in London killed more than 4,000 people. The thick, dirty fog was caused by smoke from coal fires, which are now banned in the city.

